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Cambridge Literature *Response Template*

The exact formula that earns marks in 0475 · 2010 · 0500 · 1123

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74K+	4	FREE
MONTHLY VIEWS	SYLLABUSES	FIRST CLASS

SECTION 1

The Paragraph Formula

Every Cambridge Literature paragraph should follow this exact structure. One formula. Every t

Q — **QUOTE**

Select a short, precise quotation from the text.

Avoid long quotes. 3–8 words is ideal. The shorter and more targeted, the better.

T — **TECHNIQUE**

Name the literary technique used.

Metaphor · Simile · Personification · Imagery · Repetition · Structure · Tone · Irony · Contrast

E — **EFFECT**

Explain the effect on the reader.

Start with: 'This suggests...' / 'The reader feels...' / 'This creates a sense of...'

T — **THEME**

Link to the wider theme or character.

Start with: 'This reflects the theme of...' / 'This shows that [character] is...'

EXAMPLE

Applied to 'Romeo and Juliet'

QUOTE →	"What light through yonder window breaks?"
TECHNIQUE →	Metaphor (light as Juliet)

SECTION 2

5 Phrases That Earn Marks

Use these sentence starters in every paragraph. They signal examiner awareness.

1. **"This suggests that..."**
   Connects your quote to its deeper meaning. Shows interpretation, not just copying.

2. **"The [verb / noun / adjective]..."**
   Naming the word class shows technique awareness. Never quote without labelling.

3. **"The reader feels..."**
   Demonstrates effect on audience — worth dedicated marks in most mark schemes.

4. **"This reflects the theme of..."**
   Zooms out to the big picture. Separates C-grade answers from A-grade answers.

5. **"Significantly..."**
   Signals your strongest point. Tells the examiner: this one matters most.

SECTION 3

Full Essay Structure

INTRODUCTION

State your main argument in 2–3 sentences. Mention the author's intention.
Do NOT retell the story. Never start with 'This text is about...'

PARAGRAPH 1–3

One point per paragraph. Use the Q→T→E→T formula every time.
Each paragraph = one piece of evidence + full analysis.

CONCLUSION

Return to your main argument. How does the author achieve their purpose?
Link your three points together in 2–3 sentences. No new quotes.

Never summarise what happens. A full sentence quote rarely earns